

Photograph by ASHISH SAHI



DESIGN REPERTOIRE
From India to Dubai, Aparna Kaushik's studio specialises in creating bespoke spaces for luxury projects across the globe

MINIMALISM IS A MYTH

In a world obsessed with less is more, Kaushik is a proud maximalist. She labels ultra-minimalist homes as a facade. "Life is not Zen; life is in the shades of grey," she laughs. She observes that families in minimal homes inevitably add 100 things back in within a few years just to function. Borrowing a sentiment from her inspiration, Peter Marino, she questions why one would limit themselves to a few colours when the world is so naturally vibrant. Her homes are layered, textured, and built for the beautiful chaos of real life.

MULTI-GENERATIONAL MASTERCLASS

One of Kaushik's greatest recent triumphs was a Mumbai project that merged three apartments for a multi-generational family. The challenge? Marrying the tastes of a Gen Z teenager with a 75-year-old grandparent. The result was a seamless blend of, contemporary classic for the seniors; contemporary modern for the second unit; and mid-century modern for the third. By maintaining a singular architectural rhythm through the common areas and using curated furniture to pivot the mood, she proved that a home can be a collection of different lives without feeling disjointed.

ON THE HORIZON

As she looks ahead, Kaushik is focused on moving away from people-dependent processes through technology, while simultaneously doubling down on hand-work. She wants to move away from ordering furniture by code numbers and instead travel to the dens of artisans to curate bespoke pieces.

As for her ultimate dream project? "I want a haveli," she confesses. Inspired by the way Willis Polk and Peter Marino have reimagined historic estates, Kaushik hopes to one day apply her signature brand of timeless maximalism to a traditional Indian haveli, proving once and for all that great design only gets better with age.